

Troubleshooting Guide

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Find the symptom — follow the fix

SYMPTOM	LIKELY CAUSE	FIX
 Sour or rotten smell	<i>Too wet, or overfed</i>	Pause feeding one week. Mix in dry bedding to draw down moisture.
 Worms climbing the walls	<i>Too acidic, or too damp</i>	Add crushed eggshell ; ease off citrus; let the bed dry slightly.
 Fruit flies or gnats	<i>Food left exposed on top</i>	Bury scraps under bedding; lay a fresh dry top layer.
 Worms slow or sluggish	<i>Too cold, or too hot</i>	Hold the bin at 55–77°F ; bring indoors in extreme weather.
 Liquid pooling at the base	<i>Overwatered bedding</i>	Drain the reservoir; add dry bedding and feed less.
 Scraps not breaking down	<i>Pieces too large, or too few worms</i>	Chop smaller ; feed only what disappears within a few days.
 White threads in the bed	<i>Mould on un-buried food</i>	Harmless. Stir it in and bury fresh scraps deeper.
 Stop feeding now	Heat over 100°F at the core, a strong ammonia reek, or worms dying off — pause all feeding , add dry bedding, and let the bin recover before the next meal.	

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